

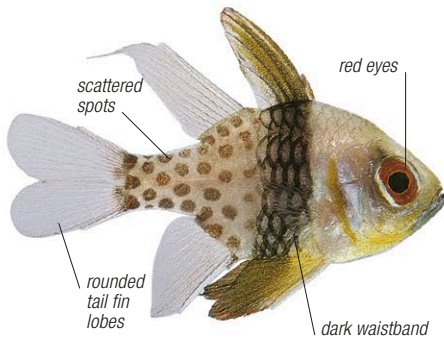
Sphaeramia nematoptera

Pajama cardinalfish



Length Up to 3¼ in (8 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

Location Indo-Pacific



This strikingly marked tropical fish belongs to a family of over 350 species, almost all of which inhabit coral reefs or lagoons. Both sexes have a yellow head, a dark “waistband,” and scattered spots toward the tail, but the female is more brightly colored. Males of this species incubate the eggs in their mouths, protecting them until they hatch.

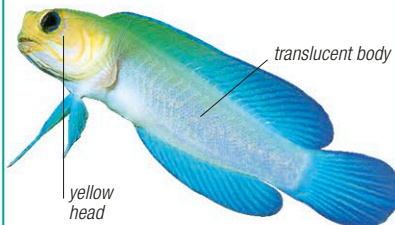
Opistognathus aurifrons

Yellowhead jawfish



Length 4 in (10 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Not recorded
Status Least concern

Location Caribbean to N. South America



This finger-sized, shallow-water fish lives on the seabed, usually in coral sand and rubble. Found in clear, coastal waters, largely in the tropics, it has a bright yellow head, but its most notable characteristic—shared by other jawfish—is its habit of creating burrows. This fish usually hovers outside the burrow, looking for prey; it mates inside. The male incubates the eggs in his mouth, spitting them out into the burrow before feeding.

Periophthalmus barbarus

Atlantic mudskipper



Length Up to 10 in (25 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location E. Atlantic



Mudskippers have tapering bodies, large heads, and protruding eyes. Like other mudskippers, this species feeds on small

animals on the mud surface, and spends most of its time out of the water. It can breathe through its skin, which it has to keep moist. It can crawl on its pectoral fins, and also skip and jump across the mud by quick, flexing movements of its body.

*Lopholatilus chamaeleonticeps*

Great northern tilefish

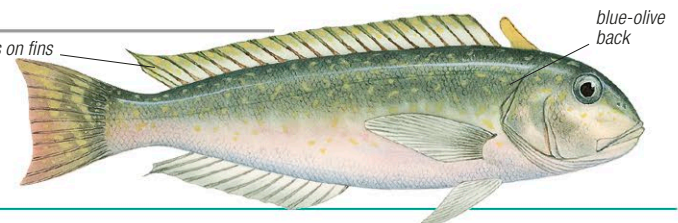


Length Up to 4 ft (1.2 m)
Weight Up to 66 lb (30 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Endangered

Location W. Central Atlantic



yellow spots on fins



This large, blunt-headed fish belongs to a family of over 40 species, all notable for building mounds or tunneling into the seabed. The tilefish creates funnel-shaped tunnels that can be up to 16 ft (5 m) across and 9¾ ft (3 m) deep. It uses these as a refuge, and also to attract prey, such as crustaceans and small fishes. Each tilefish makes an individual burrow, which it enters head-first, and from which it emerges tail-first.

Chelon labrosus

Thicklip gray mullet



Length Up to 30 in (75 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location E. North Atlantic, Mediterranean, W. Black Sea



The common name of this fish is derived from its prominent, thick upper lip. It feeds on algal material found on the seabed or

the surface scum, using its gill rakers to filter the more indigestible material. The muscular stomach and long intestines make digestion more efficient. Found in schools in relatively shallow sea water and estuaries, the thicklip gray mullet is popular both as a sport fish and a commercial species. It belongs to a family of about 80 species and was once considered to be a relative of the barracuda because of similarities in the arrangement of the fins.

*Melanotaenia boesemani*

Boeseman's rainbowfish



Length Up to 4 in (10 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Endangered

Location N.W. New Guinea



Boeseman's rainbowfish is only found in the Ajamaru Lakes region in the center of the Vogelkop

Peninsula, New Guinea. The color pattern of the males of this species is completely different from most other rainbowfishes. The head and front portion are a brilliant bluish gray, while the fins and the posterior are bright orange-red. There are alternating light and dark vertical bars in between these 2 areas. Females are less brightly colored and have a shorter dorsal fin ray. They lay 100–200 eggs.

*Leuresthes tenuis*

California grunion



Length Up to 7½ in (19 cm)
Weight Up to 3½ oz (100 g)
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

Location E. North Pacific



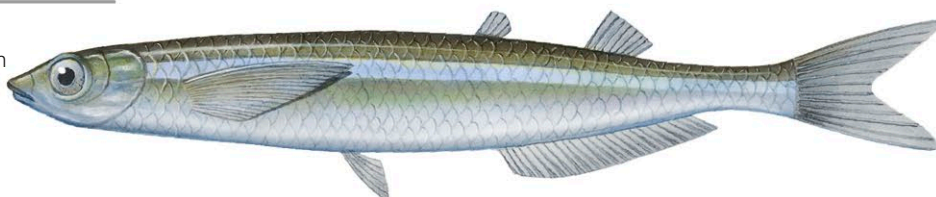
The California grunion is one of over 100 species in the American silverside family, and like most of its relatives, lives close to the

shore in large schools. It displays remarkable breeding behavior: during spring and early summer, schools of grunion strand themselves en masse on the moist sand of beaches to mate—an extraordinary sight that attracts many spectators. Spawning takes place at night for 2–6 days after a full moon, at high tide (see panel, right). The hunting of spawning grunion is a popular sport in southern California. However, only licensed fishermen are permitted to

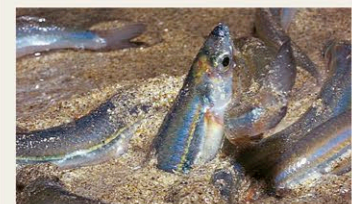
catch the stranded fishes, using only their hands. The California grunion is thought to feed on plankton and other microorganisms, possibly capturing these tiny organisms by quickly projecting its mouth.

SINGLE STRIPE

A small, slender fish, the California grunion has a silvery blue stripe running the length of its green body, and is silver-white below. It has no teeth, and its mouth is tubelike when projected.



MATING



California grunion beach themselves between waves of surf and mate on the moist sand. The female creates a shallow depression for the eggs, and the male wraps himself around the female, fertilizing the eggs as they are laid.